

BRICS 2026 – 18th SUMMIT, NEW DELHI

Complete Exam Notes for Government Exams
(Full English notes prepared from the class session – no information omitted)

How to use these notes: Headings on a black bar are the most important sections. **Grey highlighted text** marks facts most likely to be asked. The teacher says BRICS 2026 has a **very high chance** of appearing in **all upcoming government exams** ("BRICS will definitely come in the exam"). The session was taught as a set of questions and answers; these are all collected in Section 9.

1. KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

Particular	Details
Latest summit	18th BRICS Summit, 2026, held in New Delhi, India
Host	India (hosted for the 4th time)
Theme	"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability" (initials = BRICS)
Declaration adopted	New Delhi Declaration
Russia represented by	President Vladimir Putin
Total members	11
Logo	Lotus with 5 colourful petals; Namaste in the centre
Next summit (2027)	China
New Development Bank	Set up 2014 (Fortaleza Declaration); HQ Shanghai, China

2. WHY IS IT CALLED "BRICS"?

Named according to the **ENGLISH ALPHABETICAL ORDER** of the countries' names (**B-R-I-C-S**).

- Question asked: "Why was it named BRICS and not, say, rearranged letters?" – i.e. why not alphabetical order shuffled? The options were: size of GDP; English alphabetical order of names; year of joining; total population.
- Correct: **English alphabetical order of their names**. The other three options are wrong.
- **BRIC** = Brazil, Russia, India, China. When **South Africa** joined, BRIC became **BRICS**.
- The term "BRIC" was given by **Jim O'Neill**, an economist, in **2001**.

3. TIMELINE OF BRICS

Year	Event
2001	The term "BRIC" was first used (coined by economist Jim O'Neill)

2006	First ministerial meeting of the BRIC countries (a meeting – NOT a summit)
2009	First BRIC summit. Members present: Brazil, Russia, China and India. (The lecture says it took place in "New York City".)
2010	South Africa joined BRIC; BRIC became BRICS
2011	South Africa officially attended the summit in China as a member
2024	Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE and Saudi Arabia joined (5 new countries; BRICS became 10 members). Spoken in the lecture as "204".
2025	Indonesia joined → 11th member
2026	India hosted the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi

Note: The question about South Africa's joining year can be answered as **2010 or 2011**: it joined in 2010 and took part officially as a member in the 2011 summit in China. Also, the lecture places the 2009 first summit in "New York City"; many standard sources record the first BRIC summit (2009) as held in Yekaterinburg, Russia (the 2006 ministerial meeting was in New York) – check your textbook if the option appears.

4. MEMBERS OF BRICS (11)

Group	Countries
Original BRIC (4)	Brazil, Russia, India, China
Added 2010/2011 (1)	South Africa → BRICS (5)
Joined 2024 (5)	Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE (United Arab Emirates), Saudi Arabia → 10 members
Joined 2025 (1)	Indonesia → 11 members

- With 11 members, the grouping's name is now **BRICS Plus** (not "New BRICS", "Global BRICS" or "Mega BRICS").
- BRICS members are called **emerging economies**. They should not be called "developing economies", because Russia and China are also members.

5. 18th BRICS SUMMIT – NEW DELHI 2026

- Held in **New Delhi**; Russia was represented by **President Vladimir Putin**.
- **Theme: Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability** – the teacher points out that the first letters of this theme also form **BRICS** (Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation, Sustainability), so it was designed carefully.
- **Declaration:** The **New Delhi Declaration** was adopted. PM Modi asked all those who agreed with the declaration to raise their hands – everyone did. It **condemned the Pahalgam terror attack** in Jammu & Kashmir.
- **Logo:** a **lotus flower** with **five petals** of different vibrant colours; in the middle is the Indian gesture **Namaste**. The petals represent the **vibrant colours of BRICS member countries**.

Decision-making in BRICS

All decisions are by **FULL CONSENSUS** – approval of **ALL** member states is needed.

- There is no simple majority or special majority. Unless **every** member says "yes", the matter is not accepted.
- Options in the question were simple majority / full consensus / veto power – the correct one is **full consensus**: the approval of every member state is required.

6. HOSTING OF BRICS SUMMITS

India's four hosting turns

Year	Summit	Venue
2012	4th	New Delhi
2016	8th	Goa
2021	13th	Held virtually (COVID-19 was on)
2026	18th	New Delhi

Counting the 18th, **India has hosted BRICS four times**.

Recent host countries (as given in the lecture)

Year	Host
2026	India (New Delhi) – 18th
2025	Brazil
2024	Russia
2023	South Africa
2022	China
2021	India
2027	China

- There is **no tender** for hosting BRICS summits. Member countries host **turn by turn, number by number** (rotation). Earlier, with five countries, the turn rotated among five; now with 11 countries, it may rotate among 11. The **2027** summit will be in **China**.

7. NEW DEVELOPMENT BANK (NDB)

Particular	Details
Established	2014 – under the Fortaleza Declaration
At which summit	6th BRICS Summit, Fortaleza, Brazil (2014)
Headquarters	Shanghai, China

Who can become a member	Any member of the United Nations is eligible to be a member of the NDB (not only BRICS countries)
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- The teacher says the question accidentally contained its own answer: the NDB was established in 2014 with its headquarters in China (he first says Shanghai; in one repeated line he says "Beijing").

8. INDIA'S TRADE DEFICIT WITH BRICS

India's **LARGEST** trade deficit among BRICS countries is with **CHINA**.

- **Trade deficit** = when **imports are more than exports** (India sends less goods out and brings in more goods from outside).
- India trades with all BRICS countries, but its major issue is that exports to them are low and imports are very high.
- Data given: India imported about **US\$131.6 billion** from China and exported about **US\$19.5 billion** → trade deficit about **US\$112.2 billion** (as stated in the lecture).
- Conversion hint from the lecture: **1 billion = 100 crore**. To get the rupee figure, multiply 112 billion by 100 crore and then by about ₹90 per dollar – the number becomes so large that it will not even fit on a calculator.

9. PRACTICE QUESTIONS WITH ANSWERS (TAUGHT IN CLASS)

Q1 In which year was the New Development Bank (NDB) set up by the BRICS countries?

Answer: 2014 – under the Fortaleza Declaration, at the 6th BRICS Summit held in Fortaleza, Brazil.

Q2 Where is the headquarters of the New Development Bank?

Answer: Shanghai, China.

(Later in the lecture the teacher says "Beijing" by slip of tongue while repeating the establishment details; his clear answer was Shanghai.)

Q3 On what basis was the name BRICS chosen – why not "RIBCS" or any other order?

(Options: size of GDP / English alphabetical order of their names / year of joining the programme / total population)

Answer: B – According to the English alphabetical order of their names (B-R-I-C-S). GDP, year of joining and population are all wrong.

Q4 In which year did South Africa join BRIC, making it BRICS?

Answer: 2010 (joined) – and 2011 (officially attended the summit in China as a member). Both 2010 and 2011 can be accepted as the answer.

Q5 Who represented Russia at the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi?

Answer: B – Vladimir Putin, President of Russia.

Q6 Counting the 18th summit, how many times has India hosted the BRICS Summit?

Answer: Four times – 2012 (New Delhi), 2016 (Goa), 2021 (virtual, because of COVID) and 2026 (New Delhi).

Q7 The official logo of the 18th BRICS Summit is a lotus flower. Which Indian gesture/symbol is seen in the middle of the lotus?

Answer: B – Namaste.

Q8 How many members does BRICS have now?

Answer: 11 members – Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, Saudi Arabia and Indonesia (2025).

Q9 What is the official theme of the 18th BRICS Summit in India?

Answer: "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability" – the initials spell BRICS.

Q10 Where was the 18th BRICS Summit (2026) held?

Answer: New Delhi, India. (Earlier hosts: 2025 Brazil; 2024 Russia; 2023 South Africa; 2022 China; 2021 India.)

Q11 In which year did BRIC hold its first (ministerial) meeting?

Answer: 2006 – the first ministerial meeting (note: a meeting, not a summit). The first summit was in 2009.

Q12 Who coined the term "BRIC"?

Answer: Jim O'Neill (an economist), in 2001.

Q13 With 11 members now, what name is used for the grouping? (New BRICS / BRICS Plus / Global BRICS / Mega BRICS)

Answer: B – BRICS Plus.

Q14 Which category of countries do the BRICS members fall in?

Answer: B – Emerging economies (not "developing economies", because Russia and China are also members).

Q15 What did the New Delhi Declaration include, which all members supported when Modi asked those in agreement to raise their hands?

Answer: It condemned the Pahalgam terror attack in Jammu & Kashmir.

Q16 What does the BRICS India 2026 logo (five differently coloured lotus petals) represent?

Answer: The vibrant colours of the BRICS member countries.

Q17 Which declaration was adopted at the 18th BRICS Summit?

Answer: The New Delhi Declaration.

Q18 With which BRICS country does India have its largest trade deficit?

Answer: C – China (imports US\$131.6 bn, exports US\$19.5 bn, deficit about US\$112.2 bn).

Q19 How are official decisions and declarations taken at a BRICS Summit? (Simple majority / full consensus / veto power)

Answer: Full consensus – approval of all member states is needed.

Q20 Where will the 2027 BRICS Summit be held?

Answer: B – China (hosting rotates turn by turn).

Q21 Who can become a member of the New Development Bank?

Answer: C – Every member of the United Nations is eligible to become a member of the NDB (not only BRICS countries).

10. ONE-PAGE REVISION SUMMARY

- **18th BRICS Summit – New Delhi, 2026** – India's **4th** time hosting (2012 New Delhi, 2016 Goa, 2021 virtual, 2026 New Delhi). Putin represented Russia.
- Theme: **Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability** (= BRICS). Declaration: **New Delhi Declaration** – condemned the **Pahalgam attack**. Decisions by **full consensus**.
- Logo: **lotus, 5 colourful petals, Namaste** in the middle – vibrant colours of member countries.
- Name = **English alphabetical order**. BRIC term: **Jim O'Neill, 2001**. 1st ministerial meeting **2006**; 1st summit **2009**. South Africa joined **2010** (summit 2011, China).
- Members: **11** – Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa + (2024) Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, Saudi Arabia + (2025) Indonesia. Name now **BRICS Plus**; members are **emerging economies**.
- Hosts: 2021 India, 2022 China, 2023 South Africa, 2024 Russia, 2025 Brazil, 2026 India, **2027 China** (rotation, no tender).
- **NDB**: 2014, Fortaleza Declaration (6th summit, Brazil); HQ **Shanghai**; any **UN member** can join.
- Biggest trade deficit: with **China** (imports \$131.6 bn, exports \$19.5 bn, deficit ~\$112.2 bn); 1 billion = 100 crore.

Note on source: These notes are translated from an auto-transcribed Hindi lecture. The facts are given as spoken; unclear points (the "Shanghai/Beijing" HQ slip, the 2009 summit venue, the 2024 "204" typo, and the deficit arithmetic of $131.6 - 19.5 = 112.1$ vs the stated 112.2) are flagged. The teacher ends by asking students to like the class and subscribe to the channel.